

Global Cybersecurity Laws and Regulations Cheat Sheet

Estimated time needed: 5 minutes

After completing this reading, you'll be able to:

- Recognize prominent cybersecurity laws globally and their origins.
- Assess legal frameworks for data protection and cybersecurity practices.

Introduction

Understanding global cybersecurity laws and regulations is essential for organizations to ensure compliance and protect sensitive information. This cheat sheet provides an overview of key legislations governing data protection and cybersecurity practices across various jurisdictions.

Law	Origin of Governance	Description
General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)	European Union	A regulation in EU law on data protection and privacy in the European Union and the European Economic Area. It also addresses the transfer of personal data outside the EU and EEA areas.
Data Protection Act, 2018	United Kingdom	The UK's implementation of the GDPR controls how organizations, businesses, or the government use personal information.
Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act (PIPEDA)	Canada	Federal privacy law for private-sector organizations. It lays out how businesses must handle personal information during commercial activity.
Information Technology Act, 2000	India	This act provides a legal framework to secure electronic commerce and punish cybercrime. It has provisions for electronic transactions and data protection.
Network and Information Systems (NIS) Directive	European Union	The first piece of EU-wide legislation on cybersecurity aims to raise national cybersecurity capabilities, improve cooperation at the EU level, and promote a culture of security across sectors vital for the economy and society.
Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard (PCI DSS)	US (global impact)	Set security standards that ensure all companies that accept, process, store, or transmit credit card information maintain a secure environment. This set of standards originated in the United States but targeted operations worldwide. It was established by major credit card companies as a unified effort to protect cardholder data and reduce credit card fraud.
Cybersecurity Law of the People's Republic of China	China	It applies to network operators and providers of network products and was enacted to regulate cyberspace affairs and to safeguard sovereignty in cyberspace, national security, and citizens' rights.
Privacy Act 1988	Australia	Regulates how personal information is handled by specific organizations. The Australian Privacy Principles (APPs), part of the Privacy Act, guide how personal data must be collected, managed, used, and disclosed.
Act on Promotion of Information and Communications Network Utilization and Information Protection, etc. (ICN Act)	South Korea	It focuses on the secure operation of information and communications networks, protecting user personal information and providing guidelines on internet use.

To summarize, the Global Cybersecurity Laws and Regulations Cheat Sheet provides a comprehensive overview of key legislations governing data protection and cybersecurity practices globally. By analyzing, evaluating, and applying these laws, organizations can ensure compliance, mitigate risks, and protect sensitive information in an increasingly digital landscape.

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